

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Please read the notes at the end of the table carefully before completing the form.

Subject Code	SFT512
Subject Title	Fashion and Consumer Culture
Credit Value	3
Level	5
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Nil
Objectives	The subject explores the meanings of fashion and its functions in consumer culture. Students will examine cultures of fashion, styles, and clothing through critical fashion history and social science theories. Students will also investigate practices of fashion consumption as a strident condition of modern life that incorporates politics, science, and aesthetics. Key theoretical literatures on fashion and consumer cultures as well as different methodological approaches to fashion culture will be taught in the class.
Intended Learning Outcomes <i>(Note 1)</i>	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a) Identify important and relevant aspects of fashion and consumption practices and related them to a wider historical, theoretical and cultural context; b) Evaluate a variety of theoretical and methodological approaches to the study of fashion and consumer culture via the discussion of relevant academic literature; c) Develop independent and reasoned analysis of fashion phenomena to identify business opportunities and market demand.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus <i>(Note 2)</i>	1. <u>Rethinking Fashion: A Sociological Understanding</u> Definition of fashion; fashion history; fashion as a concept and a phenomenon; different approaches to fashion systems; classical and contemporary understanding of fashion; fashion and consumer culture. 2. <u>Fashion: Identity and Difference</u> Fashion and self-identity; body, clothes and fashion; body

	aesthetic; symbolic consumption of fashion; gender and fashion; fashion and social class; ethnicity and race; fashion and subcultures - gothic, punk, hip-hop, and lolita; influence of culture on global fashion consumerism 3. <u>Fashion as an Institutional System</u> The production and consumption of fashion; fashion, modernity, and social mobility; diffusion theories of fashion; fashion and the distinction of taste; consumption and social status; consumers in modern and postmodern times.																												
Teaching/Learning Methodology (Note 3)	Lectures and seminars will be used to provide students with concepts, techniques and applications relating to core topics in fashion and consumer cultures. Real life examples and implications to fashion business would be integrated into lectures to facilitate active discussion and stimulate critical thinking of students.																												
Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes (Note 4)	<table><tr><th rowspan="2">Specific assessment methods/tasks</th><th rowspan="2">% weighting</th><th colspan="3">Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)</th></tr><tr><th>a</th><th>b</th><th>c</th></tr><tr><td>1. Coursework</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>- Individual Essay</td><td>50%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr><tr><td>- Group Project</td><td>50%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr><tr><td>Total</td><td>100 %</td><td colspan="3"></td></tr></table> Continuous assessments with group and individual projects are designed to allow students’ understanding and application of social science theories to explain fashion and consumer cultures. Students will be assessed by their ability to develop independent and reasoned analysis of fashion phenomena to identify business opportunities. The group project size will be 4-5 students / group.	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)			a	b	c	1. Coursework					- Individual Essay	50%	✓	✓	✓	- Group Project	50%	✓	✓	✓	Total	100 %			
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	▪ Reading	40 Hrs
	Total student study effort	129 Hrs.
Reading List and References	<u>Books</u> 1. Foltyn, J and Petican, L (2022) <i>In Fashion: Culture, Commerce, Craft, and Identity</i>. Leiden: Brill. 2. Kawamura, Y. (2005) <i>Fashion-ology: An Introduction to Fashion Studies</i>. New York: Berg. 3. Barnard, M. (2007) <i>Fashion Theory: A Reader</i>. New York Routledge. 4. Brand, J., Teunissen, J., Zwaag, A., Berg, N. (2006). <i>The Power of Fashion: About Design and Meaning</i>. Arnhem: Uitgeverij Terra <u>Journals</u> Fashion Theory Fashion Studies Journal of Consumer Culture Journal of Consumer Research Journal of Fashion Marketing and Management <u>Internet Resources</u> www.wgsn.com www.businessoffashion.com/ www.voguebusiness.com/	

Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon subject completion. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time, overcrowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method is intended to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.